

WHAT'S NEW

Week 19 · May 4–8, 2026

Load plugins from .zip archives and URLs, search command history across every project with Ctrl+R, branch new worktrees from local HEAD or the remote default, and block actions unconditionally with auto mode hard deny rules.

Releases **v2.1.128 → v2.1.136**

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Plugins from .zip archives and URLs

`--plugin-dir` now accepts a `.zip` plugin archive in addition to a directory, and the new `--plugin-url` flag fetches a plugin archive from a URL for the current session. Useful for trying a plugin before adding it to a marketplace, or for shipping internal plugins from an artifact store.

Load a plugin straight from a URL:

terminal

```
claude --plugin-url https://example.com/my-plugin.zip
```

[Plugins guide →](#)

History search across all your projects v2.1.129

Ctrl+R reverse-search now defaults to all prompts across every project, restoring the behavior from before v2.1.124. Press Ctrl+S while searching to narrow back to the current project or session. Handy when you remember a command you ran in another

repo last week and don't want to go digging for it.

[Interactive mode: command history →](#)

Other wins

- + New `worktree.baseRef` setting (`fresh` | `head`) controls whether `--worktree`, the `EnterWorktree` tool, and agent-isolation worktrees branch from the remote default branch or local `HEAD`; the default `fresh` keeps unpushed commits out of new worktrees
- + Hooks now receive the active effort level via the `effort.level` JSON input field and the `$CLAUDE_EFFORT` environment variable, and Bash tool commands can read `$CLAUDE_EFFORT`
- + `CLAUDE_CODE_PACKAGE_MANAGER_AUTO_UPDATE` lets Homebrew or WinGet installations run the upgrade in the background and prompt to restart
- + `/mcp` now shows the tool count for connected servers and flags servers that connected with 0 tools
- + Subprocesses such as Bash, hooks, MCP, and LSP no longer inherit `OTEL_*` environment variables, so OTEL-instrumented apps run via the Bash tool no longer pick up the CLI's own OTLP endpoint
- + Several OAuth and credential reliability fixes: parallel sessions no longer dead-end at 401 after a refresh-token race, MCP OAuth refresh tokens are no longer lost when multiple servers refresh concurrently, and a rare login loop from a concurrent credential write is fixed
- + New `settings.autoMode.hard_deny` rules block matching actions unconditionally in auto mode, regardless of allow exceptions, for actions that should never run automatically even when broader allow rules apply
- + `CLAUDE_CODE_DISABLE_ALTERNATE_SCREEN=1` opts out of the fullscreen alternate-screen renderer and keeps the conversation in the terminal's native scrollbar
- + `CLAUDE_CODE_SESSION_ID` is now in the Bash tool subprocess environment, matching the `session_id` passed to hooks
- + `--channels` now works with console (API key) authentication
- + Sub-agent progress summaries now hit the prompt cache, cutting `cache_creation` token cost by roughly 3x
- + New `parentSettingsBehavior` admin key lets admins opt SDK `managedSettings` into the policy merge

[Full changelog for v2.1.128–v2.1.136 →](#)